



Handout 5.17: Build Milestones and Stuck Protocol

Name: _____ Date: _____ Station: _____ Idea path: _____

Word bank: needle, thread, knot, stitch, cut, finished Spanish: aguja, hilo, nudo, puntada, cortar, terminado

The tool rules (every day tools are out)

The six steps from Lesson 5.5, on the station count sheet.

1. The Station Manager opens the kit and counts out loud: needles, then pins, touching each one.
2. The Station Manager writes both numbers in today's row on the station count sheet.
3. The station works. Any needle or pin not in a hand is in the pin cushion or the kit. Never on the table, never on a chair, never in a pocket, never on the floor, never in your mouth.
4. At the five-minute warning everything stops and every needle and pin goes back in the cushion.
5. The Station Manager counts again, out loud, and writes the second number.
6. The numbers match and the teacher initials the row, or nobody leaves that station until it is found.

If you drop one, say so out loud. Pick it up before you do anything else. Shears and snips travel closed and pointing down. Hand them over handle first. Never walk with a threaded needle in your hand. Put it in the fabric first. Shears go back in the kit at the end, blades closed.

Today's Station Manager: _____

Copy today's numbers here as well as on the station count sheet.

	Needles out	Needles in	Match?	Pins out	Pins in	Match?
Day 1			[]			[]
Day 2			[]			[]



The stuck protocol

Before you raise your hand, three things:

- 1. READ IT AGAIN.** Find the step on your plan sheet. Put your finger on it. Say out loud where you are.
- 2. LOOK AT THE CARD.** The stitch card at your station shows the stitch in three steps, with a real stitched sample. Do two practice stitches on a scrap.
- 3. ASK YOUR PARTNER.** Show them the exact spot. Not “it’s not working.” Say “this is where the thread keeps pulling through.”

THEN stand up the “Need help” card. Keep working on something you can do. Cards get answered in the order they go up.

My stuck log

Write it down when you get stuck. This is not a punishment. It is how you find your own pattern.

#	What I was stuck on	What I tried (1, 2, 3)	What fixed it
1			
2			
3			

Day 1 milestone

By the end of today my piece is:

#	Milestone	Done	Teacher tick
1	Cut on the marked line	[]	
2	Stitch line marked	[]	
3	Pinned or clipped	[]	
4	At least one full seam or edge stitched	[]	

Clock calls today: minute 12, everyone should be cut and marked. Minute 20, everyone should be pinned.

Closure line: I hit or missed the milestone because _____.

Tomorrow I start with _____.

Teacher note for tomorrow (catch up or extend): _____

Day 2: the finishing checklist

Seven lines. Check each one yourself. Fix what fails. Then bring it to the teacher to initial.

#	The line	Mine	Teacher
1	Every seam is stitched closed, with no gap wider than the head of a pin	[]	
2	Every thread end is knotted and trimmed to about a quarter inch (not cut flush)	[]	
3	The closure works: the drawstring pulls, the button fastens through the hole, the flap folds	[]	
4	No pins are left in the item	[]	
5	The item does the job it was made for, and I tested it with the real contents	[]	
6	The raw edges are folded, whipstitched, or on a fabric that does not fray	[]	
7	My name is on the zip bag, not sewn into the item	[]	

Teacher initials: _____

One problem I found myself and fixed: _____

If anything is not finished, write here what is left and when it will be done. The first 10 minutes of Lesson 5.18 Day 1 is the finishing window.

What is left: _____

Clock calls today: minute 10: if you are behind, switch to your reduced-scope version **now**. Minute 18: start finishing. Knots, trims, closure.



Closure line: the hardest stitch on my item was _____.

The part I am proudest of is _____.

If you finish early, pick one

You do not get to sit.

1. A second small item. Pick one from the Easy list. Use the scrap bin. Plan it on the back of your plan sheet. The teacher approves it in 30 seconds. Most early finishers pick the headband, the phone sleeve, or a patchwork square.

My second item: _____

2. Station helper. Thread needles for other people. Hold fabric while a partner stitches a corner. Show somebody a stitch off the stitch card. Keep the scrap basket clear. Helping counts in the participation and safety category. Teaching a stitch correctly gets noted on your rubric.

Who I helped and with what: _____

3. Make it better. Add a reinforcement at a stress point (a bar tack at each end of a drawstring channel, or at the corners of a pocket). Or add a second row of stitching on the seam that carries the weight. Or add a hand-stitched detail. Say what you added on your display card. It counts on rubric criterion 2.

What I added, and why there: _____

If you fall behind: the reduced-scope versions

Your own reduced-scope version is on your design brief from Lesson 5.15. Here are the common ones. Switching is a decision, not a failure. You are scored on the same five criteria for what you actually made.

Original	Reduced scope
Jeans-leg pencil case with a flap and a button	Jeans-leg open-top pouch: one seam across the bottom, whipstitched edge, no flap
Towel produce bag with a drawstring	Towel flat pouch: two backstitched sides, folded top, no channel
Shirt pillow cover, three seams	One patchwork square using the shirt fabric, four sides joined
Pillowcase drawstring bag	Pillowcase flat bag: one seam, a ribbon tied at the top instead of a channel
Sweatshirt cuff wristlet with an inside pocket	Sweatshirt cuff wristlet: no pocket, both raw edges whipstitched
Patchwork square of six pieces	Patchwork square of two pieces: one seam, edges whipstitched
Sweater sleeve phone sleeve with a reinforcement	Sweater sleeve phone sleeve: one whipstitched closed end only
T-shirt tote with reinforced handles	T-shirt tote, no-sew body, with the handle join whipstitched once
Sock rice hand warmer	Sock pouch, filled and closed with a double whipstitch, no shaping
Shirt pillow cover (a second choice)	Shirt pocket cut out and whipstitched onto a scrap square as a wall pocket

My reduced-scope version (copied from my brief):

I switched at minute ____ on Day ____ . [] I did not need to switch.

Reduced-dexterity tools (ask for any of these, any day, no explanation needed)

- Self-threading (calyx eye) needle, or a large-eye embroidery needle with heavier thread
- A needle threader, or a pre-threaded needle from the teacher's card
- Binder clips or paper clips instead of straight pins
- A clamp, a hoop, or a piece of tape to hold the fabric still so only one hand has to work
- Felt instead of woven fabric, because felt does not fray and needs no edge finishing
- Fabric glue or iron-on hem tape for one of your two joins. The other join is hand stitched, so the stitch rule is still met. The iron is used by the teacher only.
- A larger item with longer stitches. It is easier to control than a small item with small stitches.

Using any of these does not change your score and is not written on your rubric.